11.4 Surgical Wound Care

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "The wound is wet and smells." **Objective** • Redness spreading 2 cm out from the incision • Pus coming from the wound • Temperature 38.2 °C	**ACTUAL** **Impaired tissue integrity** related to wound infection as evidenced by redness, purulent discharge and fever.	Within 72 hours, less redness and discharge.	• Take a wound swab as ordered. • Do aseptic wound care as prescribed. • Give antibiotics as prescribed. • Record how the wound looks every shift.	Wound improving: **goal met**.
Subjective • Gives wound pain 5/10 **Objective** • Wound tender • Guards it when moving	**ACTUAL** **Acute pain** related to wound inflammation as evidenced by pain score 5/10.	Pain 3/10 or less.	• Give analgesia before dressing changes. • Be gentle with the wound. • Use non-adherent dressings.	Controlled: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Obese • Abdominal wound under strain	**RISK** **Risk for impaired tissue integrity** as evidenced by risk factors: obesity, wound infection and raised abdominal pressure from coughing (wound dehiscence).	Wound edges stay closed.	• Teach her to splint the wound when she coughs. • Use an abdominal binder if ordered. • Report any increase in serous drainage (it can come before dehiscence).	Wound intact: **goal met**.